CSC 106 – Design for User Interaction

CA3 – Brand Guidelines

Review & Dine

Discover Bhutan's Best, One Review at a Time

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1. Brand Research & Strategy

This section outlines the foundational research and strategic thinking behind Review & Dine - Bhutan's first dedicated restaurant discovery and review platform. Building on the user research conducted in CA2, this brand strategy is grounded in real user needs, competitive gaps, and Bhutan's unique cultural context.

1.1 Target Audience

Review & Dine serves two primary user groups, each with distinct needs identified through our CA2 user personas and research.

Primary Users — Customers

Core customer segments:

- Tourists & Visitors (e.g., Tenzin Dorji, 32): International and domestic tourists seeking authentic Bhutanese dining experiences. They rely heavily on online reviews, want to see menus with photos before visiting, and need trusted community-driven recommendations.
- Local Foodies (e.g., Karma Wangchuk, 26): Tech-savvy Thimphu residents who dine out 3–4 times a week and want to discover new restaurants, filter by cuisine/ location, and share reviews with the community.
- Budget Students (e.g., Sonam Choden, 19): College students in Gyalpozhing needing price-transparent, value-for-money restaurant options they can browse on mobile before spending limited budgets.
- Food Critics & Bloggers (e.g., Rinchen Namgay, 38): Freelance food writers who need a structured, credible platform to publish reviews and build a following around Bhutanese culinary culture.

Secondary Users — Restaurant Workers

Restaurant owners and staff who use the platform to:

- Upload and manage their restaurant's menu items with photos and pricing
- Monitor customer reviews and respond to feedback
- Gain digital visibility and compete with larger, more established restaurants

1.2 Competitive Analysis

We analyzed three comparable international platforms and one regional competitor to identify market gaps and positioning opportunities for Review & Dine.

Platform	Strengths	Weaknesses	Bhutan Relevance	R&D Advantage
Zomato	Large database, community reviews, menu photos	Not optimised for Bhutan; lacks local restaurant listings	Used by some Thimphu restaurants but poorly maintained	Bhutan-first focus, local language support
TripAdvisor	Global reach, trusted reviews, traveller focus	Generic; no Bhutanese cuisine filters; slow to update	Tourists use it but listings are sparse and outdated	Real-time ratings that affect homepage position
Google Maps	Widespread use, location integration, photos	No structured menus; review format is too basic	Used widely but not designed for restaurant discovery	Dedicated menu browsing with images and prices in Nu.
Druk Eats (local)	Bhutan-specific, food delivery feature	Delivery only; no dine-in discovery or review culture	Closest local competitor but different use case	Dine-in discovery + community reviews + favourites

1.3 Brand Values & Mission

Core Brand Values

Review & Dine is built on five core values that guide every decision - from platform design to community moderation:

- Community First: We believe in the power of honest, peer-driven reviews over paid promotions. Every user's voice matters.
- Transparency: Menus with real prices, genuine reviews, and authentic photos - no hidden agendas.
- Cultural Pride: We celebrate Bhutan's diverse culinary heritage and support local restaurant owners in gaining digital visibility.
- Accessibility: Designed for every user - tourists unfamiliar with Bhutan, budget-conscious students, and seasoned local foodies alike.
- Continuous Improvement: Restaurant ratings are dynamic. Great service gets rewarded; feedback helps restaurants grow.

Mission Statement

Our Mission
"To connect Bhutan's diners with the country's best restaurants through transparent community reviews, authentic menus, and a platform built for the people of Bhutan - by the people of Bhutan."

1.4 Brand Positioning

Review & Dine positions itself as Bhutan's first and only dedicated restaurant discovery and review platform - not a food delivery service, and not a generic international review site with minimal local content.

Positioning Statement	For Bhutanese diners and visiting tourists who need trustworthy restaurant information, Review & Dine is the only community-powered platform that combines authentic peer reviews, full menu browsing with images and prices in Bhutanese Ngultrum, and smart rating-based discovery — built exclusively for Bhutan.
Unique Value Proposition	Real menus. Real reviews. Real Bhutan dining experiences - sorted by what your community actually thinks.
Market Category	Restaurant Discovery & Community Review Platform
Target Geography	Bhutan - initially Thimphu, Paro, Punakha; expanding nationwide
Price Positioning	Free for customers. Freemium for restaurant owners (basic free listing, premium features later).

1.5 Brand Voice & Personality

Review & Dine speaks with a voice that is warm, trustworthy, and enthusiastic about food - like a knowledgeable local friend who knows all the best places to eat in Thimphu.

Approachable	Trustworthy	Enthusiastic	Locally Proud
Friendly, jargon-free language that welcomes all users — from tech-savvy millennials to traditional restaurant owners	Honest, factual descriptions. We never exaggerate or mislead. Community-driven authenticity is our backbone.	We love food and it shows. Our copy celebrates flavors, stories, and the joy of a great meal.	Deeply rooted in Bhutanese culture. We use local names, references, and celebrate local cuisine.

1.6 Brand Messaging

Primary Tagline

"Discover Bhutan's Best, One Review at a Time"

Supporting Messages

- For Tourists: "Find authentic Bhutanese flavors - trusted by travelers, loved by locals."
- For Local Foodies: "Your next favourite restaurant is one review away."
- For Restaurant Owners: "Put your restaurant on Bhutan's digital food map."
- For Students: "Good food. Right price. No surprises."
- For Food Bloggers: "Build your credibility. Share your passion. Influence Bhutan's dining culture."

2. Logo Design

The Review & Dine logo is designed to be instantly recognisable, culturally resonant, and versatile across all digital and print applications. It combines culinary symbolism with the platform's review-driven identity.

Logo Concept & Rationale

Logo Name: The Plate & Star Mark

The logo consists of two visual elements combined:

- A stylised fork and spoon encircling a star — symbolising dining excellence and community ratings, the two pillars of Review & Dine.
- The logotype "Review & Dine" in bold, clean sans-serif typography (Montserrat Bold) conveys modernity and trustworthiness.

Colour Application:
Primary Version

- Charcoal Black (#2B2B2B)
- Cream Beige (#F3EFE7)
- White Background

Used for:

- Website headers
- Business cards
- Brand presentations
- Social media branding

Secondary Version

- White logo on Crimson Red (#C0392B) or Deep Navy (#2C3E50) backgrounds.

Used for:

- Dark mode applications
- Posters
- Restaurant table cards
- Promotional banners
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Review & Dine

Discover Bhutan's Best, One Review at a Time

Logo Variations

Primary (Horizontal)	Stacked (Vertical)	Icon Only (Logomark)
REVIEW & DINE DISCOVER BHUTAN'S BEST, ONE REVIEW AT A TIME	REVIEW & DINE DISCOVER BHUTAN'S BEST, ONE REVIEW AT A TIME	
Full logo with fork-star icon to the left of logotype. Used on website header, letterheads, and email signatures.	Icon above logotype. Used on mobile app splash screen, social media profile pictures, and square formats.	Fork-star icon alone. Used as a favicon, app icon, and embossed/embroidered applications where text is impractical.

3. Brand Style & Design Guide

This section defines the complete visual identity system for Review & Dine. All designers, developers, and content creators must adhere to these guidelines to ensure brand consistency across all touchpoints.

3.1 Color Palette

The Review & Dine color palette is directly inspired by the colors used in the logo design. The palette combines warm neutral tones with elegant dark accents to create a premium, modern, and welcoming restaurant brand identity.

Swatch	Primary Colors	Primary Colors	Usage
Beige Cream	Cream Beige	#E9E3D5	Main background color, clean layouts, brand warmth
Charcoal Black	Charcoal Black	#2B2B2B	Logo text, icons, headings, and primary typography
Soft Gold	Warm Gold	#C8A96B	Accent elements, highlights, stars, decorative lines

Swatch	Secondary Colors	HEX Code	Usage
Light Ivory	Ivory White	#F8F6F1	Secondary backgrounds and minimal layouts
Soft Grey	Slate Grey	#8A8A8A	Captions, secondary text, placeholders
Deep Navy	Deep Navy	#243447	Dark mode backgrounds, banners, premium sections

Figure 3: Review & Dine Brand Colour Palette

Colour Usage Rules

Cream Beige should be used as the primary brand background for a warm and elegant feel.
Charcoal Black is reserved for typography, logo outlines, and important visual elements.

Warm Gold should only be used as an accent color to maintain a premium appearance.
Avoid using overly bright or saturated colors that clash with the brand identity.
Maintain consistent color usage across all print and digital materials.

3.2 Typography

Our typographic system is clean, modern, and highly legible across both digital and print applications. We use two typefaces for all brand communications.

Typeface	Weight	Size	Application	Example Use
Montserrat	Bold (700)	36–48pt	Page & Section Headings	Page titles, H1 elements, hero text
Montserrat	SemiBold (600)	24–32pt	Sub-headings & Card Titles	H2, H3, restaurant card names
Montserrat	Medium (500)	16–18pt	Navigation & Buttons	Nav links, CTA buttons, tab labels
Open Sans	Regular (400)	14–16pt	Body & Review Text	All body copy, review text, descriptions
Open Sans	Regular (400)	12–13pt	Captions & Meta Text	Price labels, opening hours, tags
Open Sans	Bold (700)	14–16pt	Highlighted Body Text	Prices, ratings, important labels

Figure 4: Review & Dine Typography System

Typography Rules

- Never use decorative or script fonts in any branded material.
- Maintain consistent line spacing: 1.5x line height for body text, 1.2x for headings.
- Minimum font size is 12pt for print and 13px for web to ensure readability.
- Use sentence case for all body content. Use title case for headings and button labels only.

3.3 Logo Usage Guidelines

The Review & Dine logo is our most valuable brand asset. Consistent, correct usage ensures brand recognition and trust. Misuse of the logo undermines the brand's credibility.

APPROVED Logo Usage

- Always use the logo files provided in the official brand asset folder (SVG for web, EPS for print, PNG for general digital use).
- Maintain the minimum clear space of 1x the height of the "R" in "Review" around all sides of the logo.
- Use the primary (horizontal) logo for most applications. Use the stacked version only when horizontal space is constrained.
- Minimum logo size: 80px wide (digital) / 25mm wide (print) to maintain legibility.
- Use the reversed white version on dark or Crimson Red backgrounds.

PROHIBITED Logo Usage (Never Do This)

- Do NOT stretch, skew, or distort the logo in any direction.
- Do NOT recolour the logo with off-brand or unauthorised colours.
- Do NOT place the logo on complex, busy background photographs.
- Do NOT add drop shadows, outlines, or additional visual effects to the logo.
- Do NOT recreate the logo manually — always use the official master files.
- Do NOT use the logomark alone in contexts where the brand name needs to be established.

3.4 Images / Photograph Usage

Photography is central to the Review & Dine experience. High-quality, authentic images of food and restaurants build trust and drive engagement. All imagery must align with the following standards.

Photography Style	Warm, natural lighting. Overhead or 45-degree food shots. Authentic restaurant environments — not overly staged. Real dining moments over stock photography.
Food Photography	Images must show real menu items as served. Minimum resolution: 1200×900px (web), 300dpi (print). File format: JPEG (web), TIFF (print).
Restaurant Photography	Exterior and interior shots showing authentic ambience. Include people where possible — real staff and real customers (with consent). Avoid empty, sterile environments.

Review Photo Guidelines	Customer-submitted photos are welcome. Platform auto-compresses to under 2MB. Blurry, offensive, or irrelevant images may be removed by moderators.
Prohibited Content	Stock photo-style generic imagery, heavily filtered Instagram-style edits (desaturated, heavy grain), photos with logos of competitor platforms, and images that misrepresent a dish.
Image Aspect Ratios	Restaurant card thumbnails: 16:9. Menu item photos: 4:3. Hero banner: 21:9. Profile photos: 1:1 (circle cropped).

3.5 Design Elements

Consistent visual motifs reinforce brand recognition and create a distinctive, cohesive look across all Review & Dine touchpoints.

Design Element	Description & Application
Star Rating System	Five-star system using Golden Saffron (#F39C12) filled stars and Light Grey (#F2F2F2) empty stars. Appears on restaurant cards, detail pages, and review submissions. Half-stars are not used — whole stars only for clarity.
Rounded Cards	Restaurant and menu item cards use 12px border radius for a modern, approachable aesthetic. Cards cast a subtle box shadow (0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.10)) to lift them off the background.
Iconography	Line icons from the Lucide icon set — consistent 24×24px grid. Used in navigation (Home, Favourites, Menu, Profile), reviews (star, calendar, location pin), and restaurant info (clock, phone, fork-knife).
Tag/Badge System	Pill-shaped category tags (cuisine type, price range, city) using Light Grey backgrounds and Slate Grey text. Selected/active tags use Crimson Red background with white text.
Divider Lines	1px Crimson Red horizontal rules used as section separators in documents and headers on the web platform. Light Grey (2px) dividers used between content sections.
Grid System	12-column grid for desktop (1200px max-width), 4-column for tablet, 1-column for mobile. Content cards follow a 3-column (desktop), 2-column (tablet), 1-column (mobile) responsive grid.
Bhutanese Motif Accent	Subtle geometric patterns inspired by traditional Bhutanese textile weaving (kishuthara) used as background textures on hero banners and collateral backgrounds at 5–8% opacity to add cultural depth without visual clutter.

4. Brand Collaterals

The following six branded collaterals have been developed for Review & Dine to ensure a consistent and professional brand presence across all communications. Business cards, envelopes, and letterheads are included as compulsory items, along with three additional collaterals.





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